man promoted was an M.D., however, and that pointed out a practical disadvantage of my second-class status.

It depressed me and, to add to the depression, I was hearing nothing from Brad on The Stars t like Dust—.

The only thing to do was to begin putting my robot stories into shape for Marty, making minor adjustments to remove internal inconsistencies.

I decided to include all eight robot stories that Campbell had published over a nine-year period, from "Reason" in 1941 to "The Evitable Conflict," which was soon to appear. Then, too, as a first story, I would include "Robbie," which Campbell had rejected but which Pohl had published in Super Science as "Strange Playfellow." These were quite enough, with some added introductory material, to make up a 70,000-word book, so that there was no need to include "Robot AL-76 Goes Astray" or "Victory Unintentional," which I thought were inferior.

I called the collection Mind and Iron.

2 3

On March 8, my first scientific publication appeared. The February 1950 issue of the Journal of the American Chemical Society contained, on page 820, a nine-page paper entitled "On the Reaction Inactivation of Tyrosinase During the Aerobic Oxidation of Catechol" by Isaac Asimov and Charles R. Dawson. It was, of course, the short version of my dissertation.

It was not only my first scientific publication, it also was my longest and my best.

Over the next three years I was to publish six papers on research work done in my Boston University laboratory. All of them were in collaboration with others who did the actual work, though I did the supervision and the actual writing. All those papers were unimportant and I enjoyed none of them. After 1953, I never again published a scientific paper involving research.

The trouble was that I hated writing research papers. Even while I still thought of myself as a researcher, I scorned and detested the writing end of it. Writing a research paper is a tedious and stylized job. You cannot write as you wish; you cannot use English; you cannot have fun.

It was even worse than being back in the Navy Yard making certain that no